

Gophish Simulation

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Objective:

To gain an understanding of Gophish and practical knowledge of real-life phishing attacks

Step 1: Set up Gophish

I set up Gophish in Kali Linux using
git clone

<https://github.com/Commando-X/vuln-bank.git>

cd vuln-bank

docker-compose up --build

./gophish

```
(kali@kali) ~/Downloads/gophish
$ ./gophish
time="2025-10-18T14:17:47-04:00" level=warning msg="No contact address has been configured."
time="2025-10-18T14:17:47-04:00" level=warning msg="Please consider adding a contact_address entry in your config.json"
goose: migrating db environment 'production', current version: 0, target: 20220321133237
OK 20160118194630_init.sql
OK 20160131153104_0.1.2_add_event_details.sql
OK 20160211211220_0.1.2_add_ignore_cert_errors.sql
OK 20160217211342_0.1.2_create_from_col_results.sql
OK 20160225173824_0.1.2_capture_credentials.sql
OK 20160227180335_0.1.2_store-smtp-settings.sql
OK 20160317214457_0.2_redirect_url.sql
OK 20160605210903_0.2_campaign_scheduling.sql
OK 20170104220731_0.2_result_statuses.sql
OK 20170219122503_0.2.1_email_headers.sql
OK 20170827141312_0.4_utc_dates.sql
OK 20171027211457_0.4.1_maillogs.sql
OK 20171208201932_0.4.1_next_send_date.sql
OK 20180223101813_0.5.1_user_reporting.sql
OK 20180524203752_0.7.0_result_last_modified.sql
OK 20180527213648_0.7.0_store_email_request.sql
OK 20180830215615_0.7.0_send_by_date.sql
OK 20190105192341_0.8.0_rbac.sql
OK 20191104103306_0.9.0_create_webhooks.sql
OK 20200116000000_0.9.0_imap.sql
OK 20200619000000_0.11.0_password_policy.sql
OK 20200730000000_0.11.0_imap_ignore_cert_errors.sql
OK 20200914000000_0.11.0_last_login.sql
OK 20201201000000_0.11.0_account_locked.sql
OK 20220321133237_0.4.1_envelope_sender.sql
time="2025-10-18T14:17:47-04:00" level=info msg="Please login with the username admin and the password 36d09c6790052c10"
time="2025-10-18T14:17:47-04:00" level=info msg="Creating new self-signed certificates for administration interface"
time="2025-10-18T14:17:47-04:00" level=info msg="Starting phishing server at http://0.0.0.0:80"
time="2025-10-18T14:17:47-04:00" level=info msg="Starting IMAP monitor manager"
time="2025-10-18T14:17:47-04:00" level=info msg="Starting new IMAP monitor for user admin"
time="2025-10-18T14:17:47-04:00" level=info msg="Background Worker Started Successfully - Waiting for Campaigns"
time="2025-10-18T14:17:47-04:00" level=info msg="TLS Certificate Generation complete"
time="2025-10-18T14:17:47-04:00" level=info msg="Starting admin server at https://127.0.0.1:3333"
2025/10/18 14:17:59 http: TLS handshake error from 127.0.0.1:58454: remote error: tls: bad certificate
2025/10/18 14:17:59 http: TLS handshake error from 127.0.0.1:58456: remote error: tls: bad certificate
2025/10/18 14:17:59 http: TLS handshake error from 127.0.0.1:58458: remote error: tls: bad certificate
time="2025-10-18T14:18:04-04:00" level=info msg="127.0.0.1 - [18/Oct/2025:14:18:04 -0400] \"GET / HTTP/2.0\" 207 51 \"\" Mozilla/5.0 (X11; Linux x86_64; rv:140.0) Gecko/20100101 Firefox/140.0"
time="2025-10-18T14:18:04-04:00" level=info msg="127.0.0.1 - [18/Oct/2025:14:18:04 -0400] \"GET /login?next=%2F HTTP/2.0\" 200 1038 \"\" Mozilla/5.0 (X11; Linux x86_64; rv:140.0) Gecko/20100101 Firefox/140.0"
time="2025-10-18T14:18:04-04:00" level=info msg="127.0.0.1 - [18/Oct/2025:14:18:04 -0400] \"GET /images/logo_inv_small.png HTTP/2.0\" 200 1118 \"https://127.0.0.1:3333/login?next=%2F\" Mozilla/5.0 (X11; Linux x86_64; rv:140.0) Gecko/20100101 Firefox/140.0"
```

Step 2: Login

I logged in using the provided password when compiling as marked in the above figure.

 gophish Login

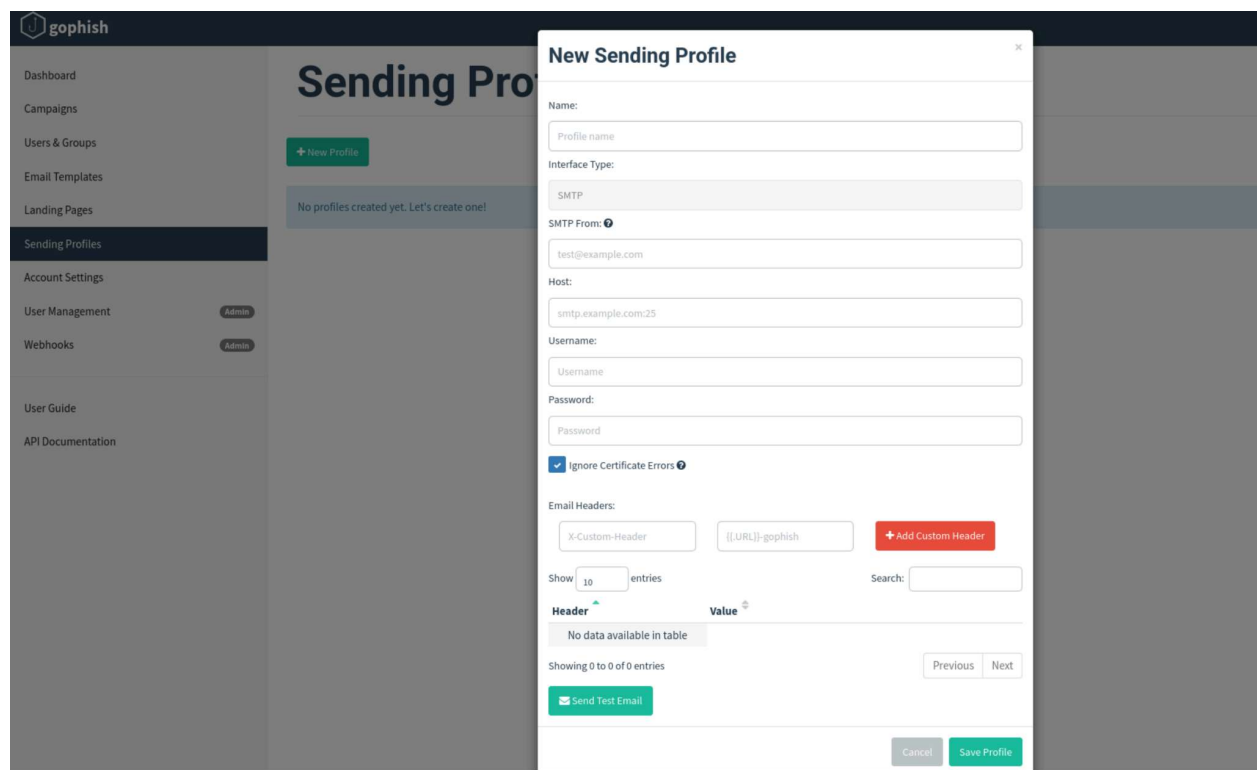


Please sign in

Sign in

Step 3: Logged in using dummy gmail

I logged in to gophish for the simulation of a phishing attack through mail. For that I used a dummy email and used that email as the sender of phishing emails.



The screenshot shows the Gophish web interface with the 'New Sending Profile' modal open. The background shows the 'Sending Profiles' section with a '+ New Profile' button and a message 'No profiles created yet. Let's create one!'. The modal form includes the following fields and options:

- Name:** Profile name
- Interface Type:** SMTP
- SMTP From:** test@example.com
- Host:** smtp.example.com:25
- Username:** Username
- Password:** Password
- ☒ **Ignore Certificate Errors**
- Email Headers:** X-Custom-Header, [{{URL}}]-gophish, + Add Custom Header
- Show:** 10 entries
- Search:** Search
- Header/Value Table:** No data available in table
- Showing:** 0 to 0 of 0 entries
- Buttons:** Send Test Email, Cancel, Save Profile

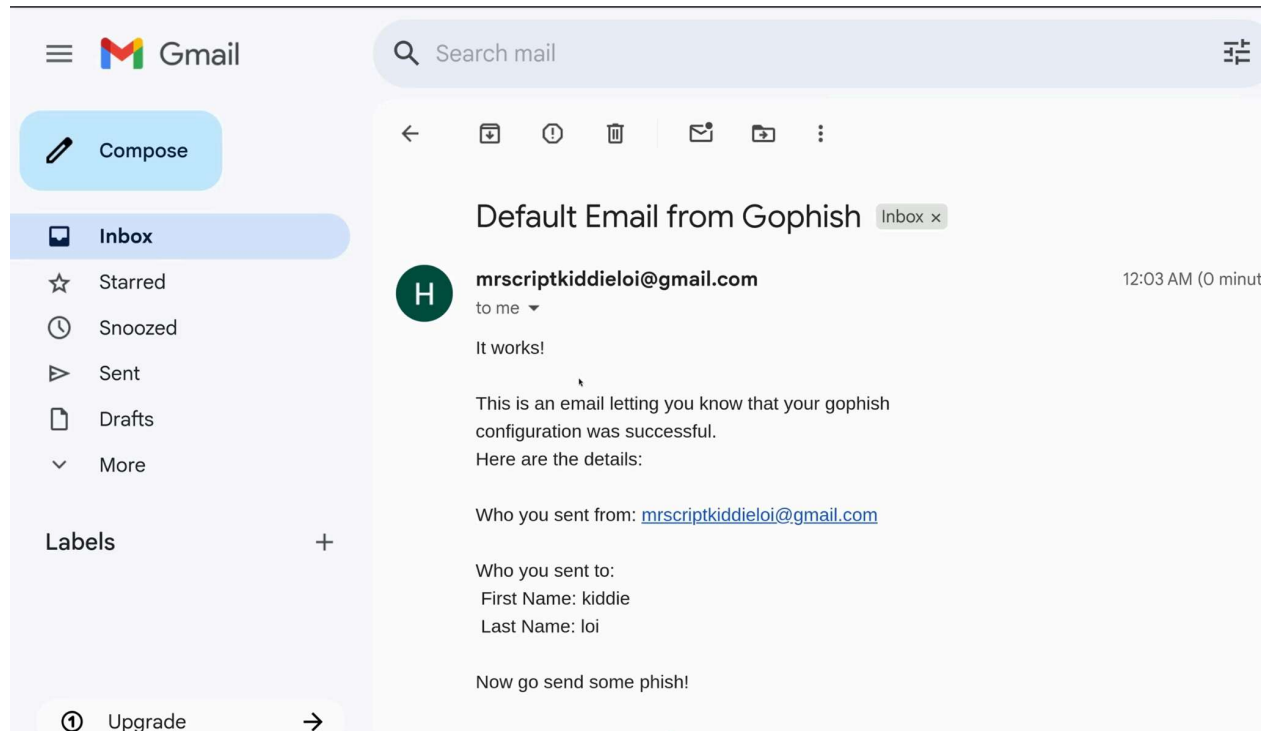
Step 4: Creating templates for phishing mails

Using the templates profile i created a dummy phishing mail for educational purpose.

The image shows a screenshot of the Gophish web interface. On the left is a dark sidebar with a menu containing: Dashboard, Campaigns, Users & Groups, Email Templates (highlighted), Landing Pages, Sending Profiles, Account Settings, User Management (with an 'Admin' button), Webhooks (with an 'Admin' button), User Guide, and API Documentation. The main content area has a header 'Email Templates' and a '+ New Template' button. Below this is a message: 'No templates yet. Let's create one!'. A modal window titled 'New Template' is open in the foreground. It contains the following fields and controls: a 'Name:' label with a 'Template name' input field; an 'Import Email' button; an 'Envelope Sender:' label with an email address input field containing 'First Last <test@example.com>'; a 'Subject:' label with an 'Email Subject' input field; tabs for 'Text' and 'HTML' (the 'HTML' tab is active); a large 'Plaintext' text area; a checked checkbox for 'Add Tracking Image'; an '+ Add Files' button; a 'Show 10 entries' control; a 'Search:' input field; a table header with a 'Name' column; a message 'No data available in table'; and pagination controls showing 'Showing 0 to 0 of 0 entries' with 'Previous' and 'Next' buttons.

Step 5: Sending phishing emails

After creating the phishing templates, I used it to set emails to my account.



Conclusion

I successfully gained knowledge on using and understanding how phishing emails works and how to create one.